

East to west

China sent silk, porcelain, jade, tea, and spices west along the Silk Road toward Europe. Among the many inventions that traveled west were paper and gunpowder.



SCALE

0 500 miles
0 500 kilometers

Chinese porcelain

Chinese tea leaves

Chinese silk clothing

Missionaries traveled to Asia in 781 CE to spread the Christian religion.

Christian missionaries

Buddhist monks spread their religion from India to China in the first century CE.

Buddhist monks

Camel trains

Trains (groups) of two-humped camels transported travelers and goods along the Silk Road.

Arab dhow

These traditional Arab sailing ships carried goods across the Indian Ocean and into the Persian Gulf.

Huge fleets of ships called junks sailed across the Indian Ocean.

Chinese junk